

only his weapons and armor, but also a weighty set of digging tools, which he needed when the legion stopped to make camp.

Conditions of service

Life was tough for a legionary. Some complained of harsh treatment. For those sent to the farthest outposts of the Roman Empire, the weather was an added problem. For

example, one soldier stationed in northern Britain asked for wool socks, underpants, and sandals—presumably he found the cool, wet climate very different from the one in his homeland, wherever that was.

Legionaries joined the army for between 20 and 25 years. They were not officially allowed to marry, but many did. They learned new skills and usually received regular pay, as well as good medical treatment. On leaving the army, they were given land, although this was eventually changed to a gift of

HADRIAN'S WALL IN NORTHERN BRITAIN WAS A FRONTIER OF THE ROMAN EMPIRE. BEYOND IT LIVED NON-ROMAN PEOPLE. THE ROMANS CALLED THEM BARBARIANS.

WEIRD WORLD

THE WORST PUNISHMENT FACED BY A COHORT WAS THE PRACTICE OF DECIMATION, WHEN THE SOLDIERS LINED UP AND EVERY TENTH MAN WAS CLUBBED OR STONED TO DEATH. ("DECI" MEANS 10, AS IN THE WORD DECIMAL.)

